# Emotions and feelings

The same black can evoke **strength** in one of us and **heaviness** in another, sometimes even both in one day. There is no single fixed effect. It depends on our body, experience, culture and situation.

## Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

### Self-assurance

A feeling that you **stand firm** and need not apologise to anyone.

#### And why?

A well-fitting black jacket, a simple dress or striking jewellery can look decisive. Black can let the face, the movement and the detail stand out. Sometimes it is the most striking thing in the room.

Ask yourself

*"When do I feel most like myself?"*

### Protection

A feeling that there is **a firm boundary** around you and nobody sees inside.

#### And why?

In some contemporary spiritual approaches black is used as a symbol of protection. Protection after a hurt is not a failure. At the same time it is good to notice whether the boundary serves you, or separates you from people.

And what if I asked you now?

*"What do I need to protect today, and from what?"*

### Mystery

A wish to **keep something just for yourself** and not explain.

#### And why?

Darkness limits information and the imagination starts to work. Mystery can be pleasant when you choose it yourself. Less pleasant is a mystery that becomes a wall.

And try answering now

*"What am I keeping to myself for now and feel fine with it?"*

### Sadness

A feeling that **everything has gone quiet and dark**.

#### And why?

In European history black had a strong place in mourning dress. It does not show the size of the pain, though. A woman in a coloured jumper can grieve deeply and a woman in a black dress can go to a concert. Grief has no obligatory colour chart.

And now one question for you

*"What am I missing and who could I tell?"*



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## Feelings and experience

Deeper and slower states that settle in us. You often recognise them only after a while.

### Privacy

A feeling that you **need not be available** and can rest for a while.

#### And why?

After a long period when you were constantly available, black may attract you as privacy. Simple clothing, fewer stimuli, less need to explain yourself. The benefit comes from the whole transition into a calmer regime.

Ask yourself

*“When did I last not answer at once and nothing happened?”*

### Boundary

A feeling that **you know where you end** and someone else begins.

#### And why?

A black scarf, a smooth stone or a piece of fabric can be taken as a personal symbol of privacy. Work with boundaries need not end in a firm "nobody in". Perhaps you do not need to share everything. But perhaps you are already hiding even what you would like to say.

And what if I asked you now?

*“Whom do I wish to let closer?”*

### Fear of being seen

A feeling that in another colour **you will be too much in view**.

#### And why?

When you want a pink jumper, but every time you return it because "I will be too visible in it", it is this very worry that deserves attention. But if you love black and a coloured jumper does not tempt you at all, you do not have to re-educate yourself.

And try answering now

*“Do I choose black because I love it, or because I am afraid to be seen in another colour?”*

### Celebration

A feeling that it is **an exceptional evening** and you are part of it.

#### And why?

A black dress, a dinner jacket and evening suits belong to celebrations. The same black dress can mean "I'm saying goodbye", "I'm celebrating" or "this simply suits me". Without the circumstances you don't know.

And now one question for you

*“What am I looking forward to so much that I would wear something exceptional for it?”*



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## My black is not the same as your black

The colour itself **experiences nothing**. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the **experience** sticks to it. The colour then becomes a **shortcut**. That is why **your own reaction** is the most important.

- **Black dress**
  For one a celebration, for another a funeral.
- **Black coat**
  For one elegance, for another hiding.
- **Black room**
  For one depth and privacy, for another a cave.
- **Black hair**
  For one a frame for the face, for another a change she does not want.
- **Black stone**
  For one protection, for another a piece of earth on the road.

### Why does it attract me right now?

Perhaps you feel well put together in it, it combines easily, you enjoy its strength or you need not deal with every coloured detail in it. And perhaps it really helps you have a sense of privacy. **A black wardrobe is not automatically a sign of sadness, reserve or a strong personality.**

### Does it really slim?

Research on the perception of clothing shows that lower lightness can, under certain conditions, lead to a narrower impression of the figure. It is not a universal trick, though, that overrides every cut, material and light. A black close-fitting glossy garment and a black looser matte dress do not look the same. Try asking yourself two questions. Do I like how I look in it? Or does it mainly calm me that it will perhaps hide something of me?

### When to take black away

When a particular whole weighs on you, you lose your bearings in it or it keeps reminding you of a period you want to step away from. Start with one change. A lighter fabric near the face, an uncovered window or a different cover. Watch the real difference, not the expectation that a colour must fix something at once. **Black can be your choice. It does not have to be your obligation.**

Ask yourself

*"Which sentence about black is loudest in me? Whose is it, actually?"*



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